VERSION 119 · OPERATIONS GUIDE

Payments, Cash Jobs and Pro Tokens

How customers pay, how Trothen gets paid, and how escrow still protects the customer while cards and in-app mobile money aren't available yet.

Trothen (trothenpro.com) · Prepared for Walter Cecil Wisner and the Trothen team · 28 October 2026

Covers the code in package **trothen-v119-files.zip** (includes the v118.1 fix). Screenshots were taken from the real app running v119.

Contents

1 Summary in one page

2 Who pays whom: the money map

3 Way 1: Protected by Trothen (escrow)

4 Way 2: Cash to the pro after the job

5 Pro tokens: what they are and how pros buy them

6 Commission on cash jobs, step by step

7 Everything else tokens can pay for

8 The pro's screens

9 The finance team's daily routine

10 Admin settings explained

11 When things go wrong: every case

12 Safety and fraud controls

13 Is this best practice? Honest assessment

14 Status reference

15 Reports and accounting

16 Go-live checklist

17 What still needs business or legal action

18 How I tested it

19 Glossary

How to read this guide

I wrote this for you, Joseph and the people who will run Trothen day to day: finance, customer service and admins. Sections 1 to 4 explain the idea. Sections 5 to 8 show what pros see. Sections 9 and 10 are the working instructions for staff. Sections 11 to 17 cover the rules, the risks and what must happen before going live. All amounts use the app's current test exchange rate of **US$1 = L$190**. Your real rate will differ.

1. Summary in one page

The problem

Trothen can't take cards or in-app mobile money yet. Until the MTN connection (LCMMMI) and a licensed payment partner are approved, nothing can be charged automatically. Many customers in Liberia, Ghana and Nigeria will also prefer to pay in cash. You told me two things matter: Trothen must still get paid, and the escrow promise to protect the customer must not be lost.

The answer, in four sentences

1. **Customers choose how to pay when they book.** *Protected by Trothen* is shown first and marked "Recommended"; *Cash to the pro after the job* is the other choice.
2. **Protected jobs keep full escrow.** The customer sends mobile money to Trothen's own business number, using a one-time code the system makes. The finance team confirms it, and only then is the pro asked. Trothen holds the money until the customer says the job is done.
3. **Cash jobs pay Trothen through the pro's tokens.** Pros buy tokens from Trothen in advance. When a pro accepts a cash job, Trothen's commission (their plan rate of the job price) is taken from their tokens. No tokens, no accepting.
4. **The customer is protected in both cases**, with escrow on protected jobs. On cash jobs: pay only after the work, a written contract, an ID-checked pro, ratings and the dispute team. The app says plainly that cash isn't covered by escrow.

How Trothen earns

Kind of job	What Trothen receives	When
Protected (escrow)	The customer's service fee (9%, $2.99 to $25), plus the pro's commission taken out of their payout. A pro can choose to pay that commission from tokens instead.	Fee: when the customer pays. Commission: when the pro is paid out.
Cash	The pro's commission only (13% Starter, 12% Pro, 10% Super Pro of the job price), paid from tokens the pro bought in advance. There's no customer service fee on a cash job.	When the pro accepts the job, corrected when the customer confirms what they paid.
From every pro	Monthly plan fee (still switched off), self-serve ads and driver passes. Each can be paid in tokens.	As they happen.

The one-line rule

Tokens only ever pay Trothen. They never touch the customer's money. Escrow money is held by Trothen and goes to the pro only when the customer confirms the job is done, or the dispute team decides.

2. Who pays whom: the money map

Three parties are involved: the customer, the pro and Trothen. The diagram shows every way money moves. The solid line from customer to Trothen is a protected job. The dotted line from customer to pro is a cash job. The thick line from pro to Trothen is tokens.

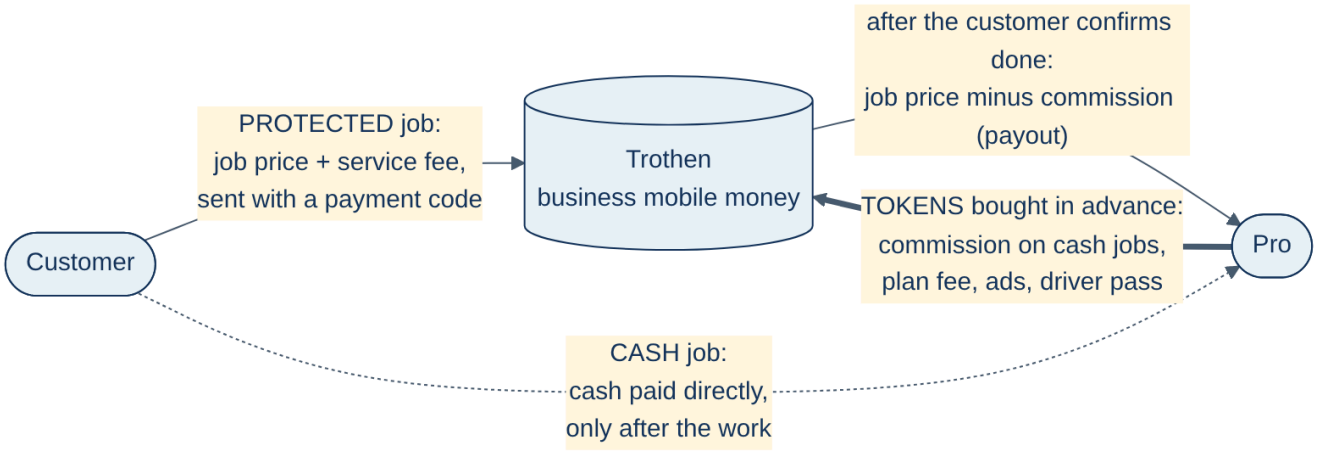


Figure 2.1: The money map

The three money pots

Pot	What it is	Who it belongs to
Escrow (held)	Money customers paid for protected jobs that aren't finished yet.	The customer until the job is done, then the pro. **Never Trothen's to spend.**
Pro balances (released)	Escrow released to a pro after the customer confirmed the job, waiting for a payout.	The pro. Paid out by finance by mobile money.
Unspent tokens	Money pros paid for tokens they haven't used yet.	Prepaid fees owed to the pro in services. It becomes Trothen's revenue only when spent.

Only service fees, commission actually taken and tokens actually spent are Trothen's revenue. Your accountant should keep the three pots above separate from Trothen's own money. Ideally, escrow sits in its own account.

3. Way 1: Protected by Trothen (escrow)

This is the option I recommend customers use, and the app shows it first. While in-app payments aren't available, it works through **payment codes**. You switch this on per country (section 10). Once it's on, nothing reaches the pro until Trothen has the money.

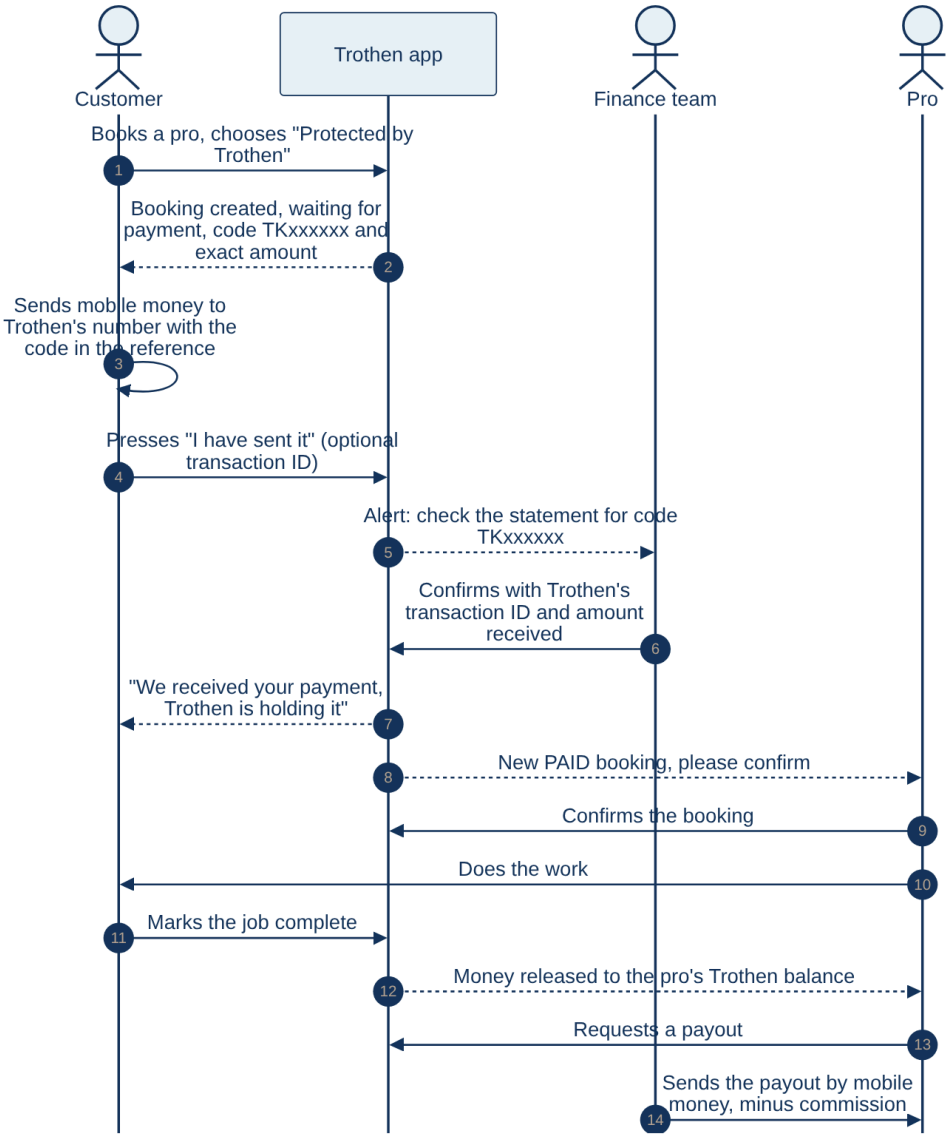
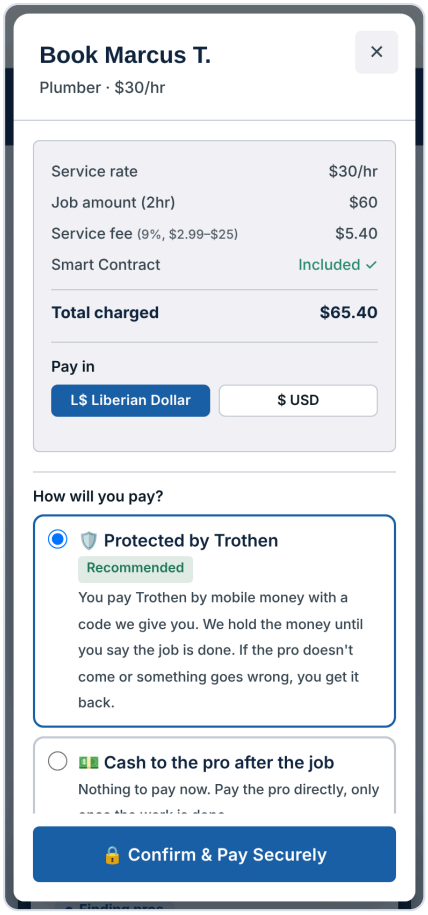
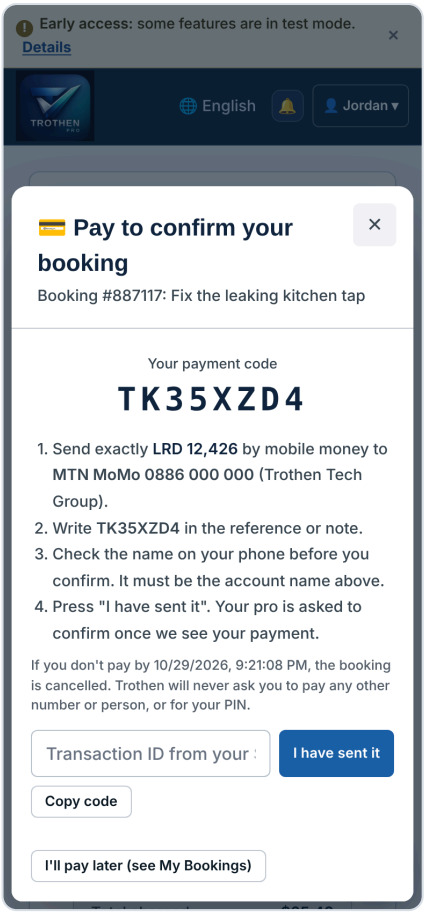


Figure 3.1: A protected booking paid by code, from booking to payout

Step by step, as the customer sees it

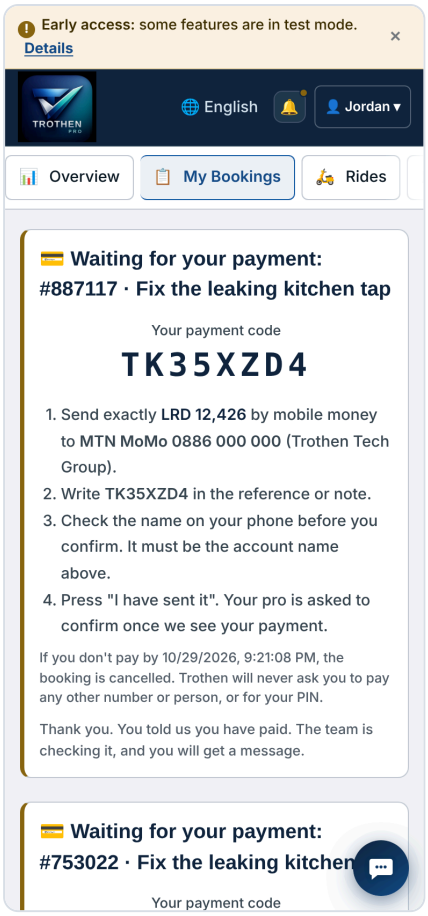


3.2: The booking form. "How will you pay?" has Protected selected and marked Recommended.

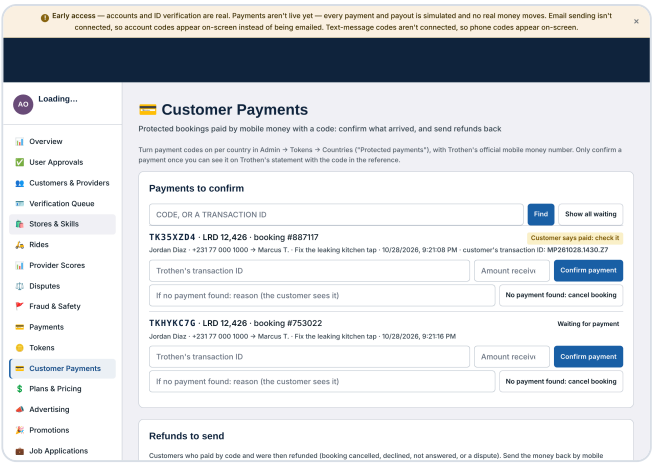


3.3: After booking, the customer gets a code, the exact amount, Trothen's number and four simple steps.

1. **The customer books and chooses "Protected by Trothen".** The booking is created as *waiting for payment*, and the pro is not told about it yet.
2. **The system makes a one-time payment code**, for example `TKV2E7AD`, and works out the exact amount in local money. Example: a $60 job plus a $5.40 service fee = $65.40, which is **L$12,426**. Codes leave out characters that are easy to confuse (0/O, 1/I/L).
3. **The customer sends exactly that amount** by mobile money to Trothen's business number, writes the code in the reference and checks that the account name on their phone matches.
4. **The customer presses "I have sent it"** and can type the transaction ID from their SMS. This only tells the finance team to look; it doesn't confirm anything.
5. **Finance finds the payment** on Trothen's mobile money statement and confirms it in *Admin → Customer Payments*, entering **Trothen's** transaction ID and the amount that arrived.
6. **Only now is the pro asked to confirm the booking.** They get the normal time to answer, counted from this moment.
7. **The pro does the work and the customer marks it complete.** The money is released to the pro's Trothen balance.
8. **The pro requests a payout.** Finance sends it by mobile money, minus Trothen's commission (or the full amount, if the pro paid the commission with tokens).



3.4: Until it's paid, the booking shows at the top of My Bookings with the code and the steps.



3.5: Admin → Customer Payments. Bookings the customer says are paid are listed first, with their transaction ID.

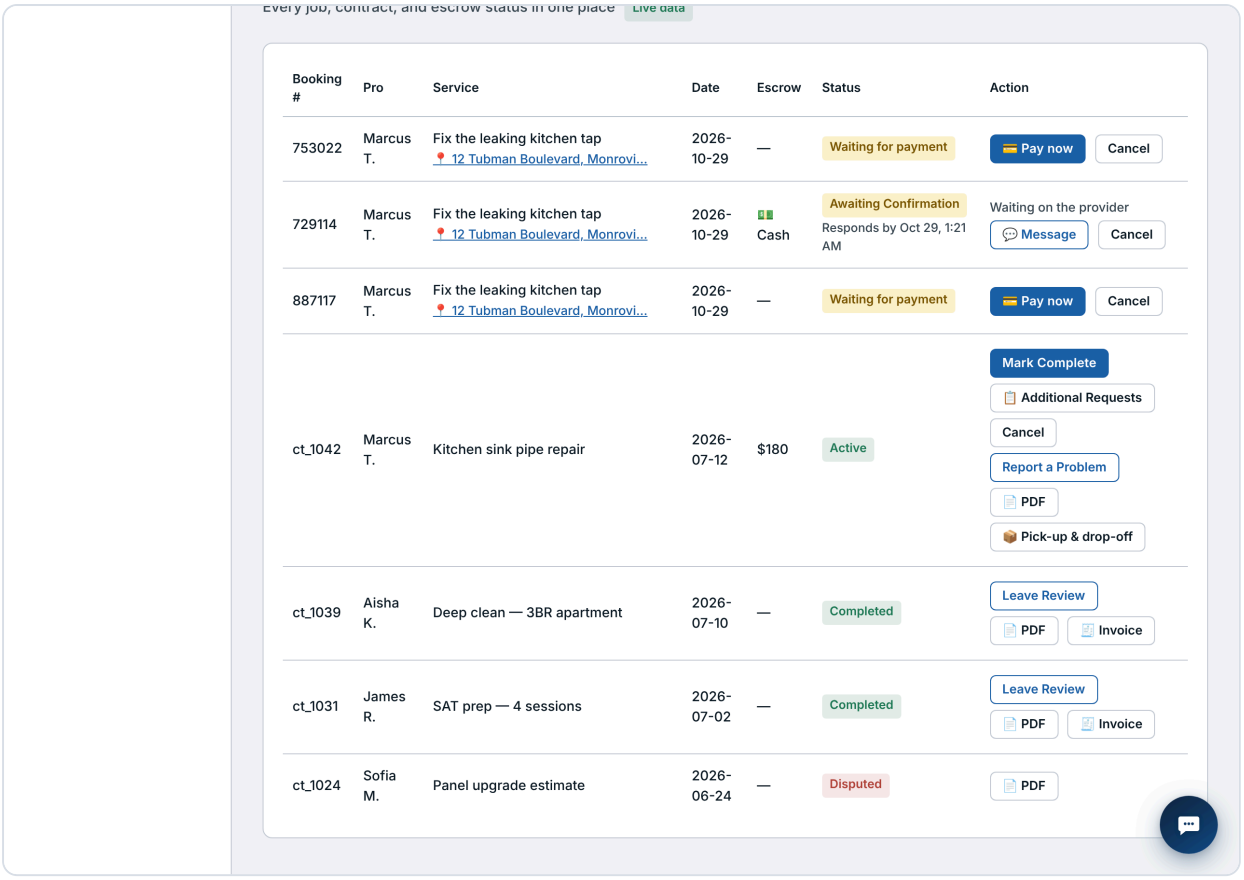


Figure 3.6: My Bookings on a computer. Unpaid bookings show "Waiting for payment" with **Pay now** (brings the code back) and **Cancel**. Cash bookings show "💵 Cash" in the Escrow column.

The rules that keep it safe

Rule	Why
The pro only sees the booking once the payment is confirmed.	A pro never travels to a job that hasn't been paid for.
"I have sent it" adds nothing by itself.	Only a person who has seen the money on Trothen's statement can confirm it.
Confirming needs Trothen's transaction ID and the amount received.	A short payment is refused. Each transaction ID can be used once only, across customer payments and token purchases, so one payment can never be counted twice.
Only super admins and the finance team can confirm.	Customer service can look but not move money.
Unpaid bookings are cancelled after 24 hours.	Only if the customer never said they paid. If they said they paid, a person must decide.
The customer can cancel before saying they paid.	After that, cancelling goes through support, so money that might have arrived isn't forgotten.
Job board: if the first pro declines or doesn't answer, the money moves to the next interested pro's booking.	The customer doesn't have to be refunded and pay again.

Every refund on a code-paid booking goes to **Refunds to send**.	Finance sends it back by mobile money and marks it sent with the transaction ID, and the customer is told.

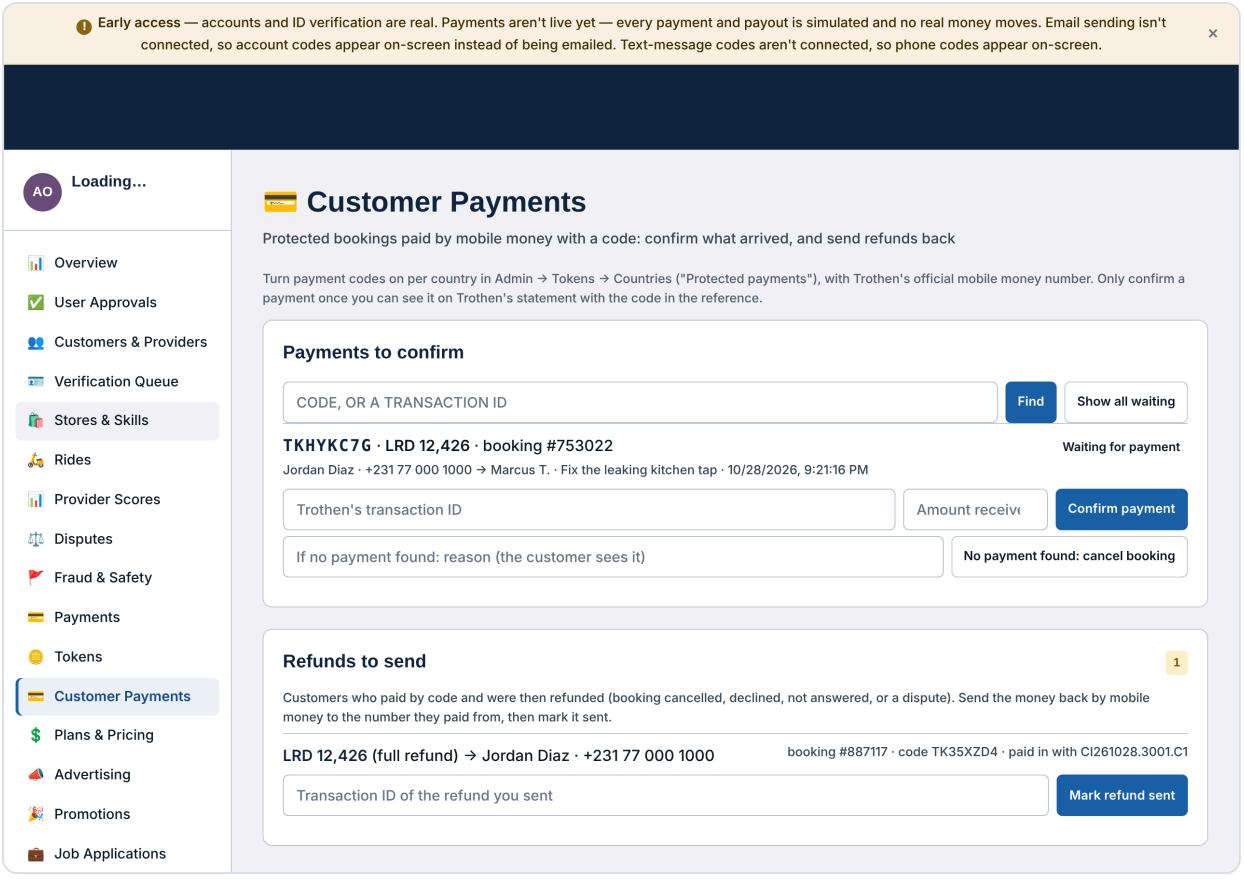


Figure 3.7: Refunds to send. Each refund shows the amount in local money, the customer, their phone, the booking and how the money came in.

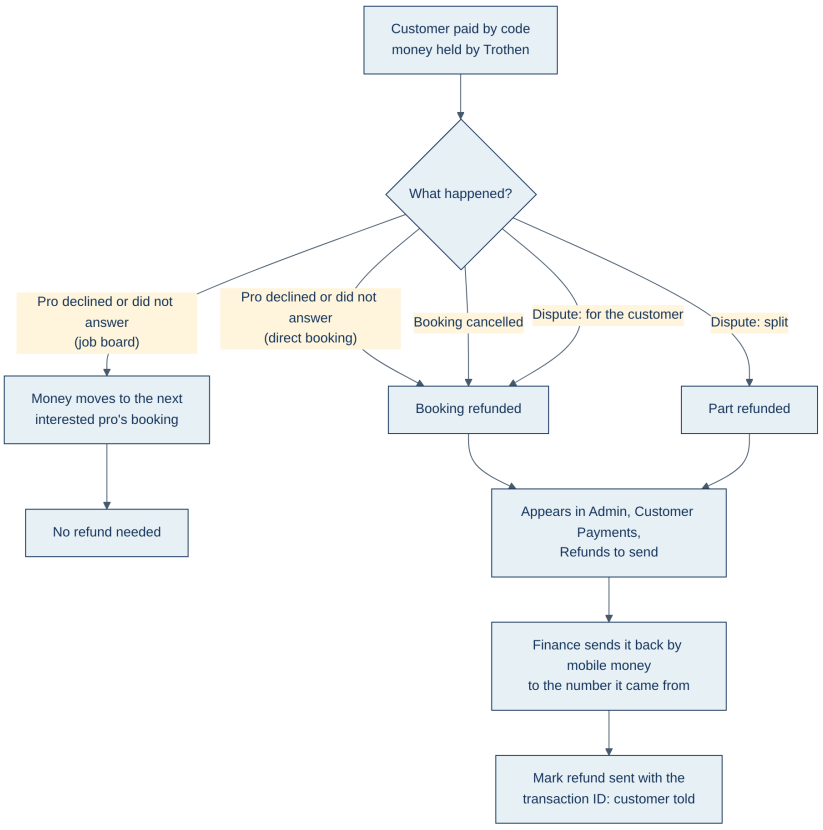


Figure 3.8: What happens to code-paid money when a booking doesn't go ahead

4. Way 2: Cash to the pro after the job

Some customers will only pay cash, and in many places that's normal. Rather than lose those jobs, or let them happen outside the app with no record and no commission, the app now supports them properly.

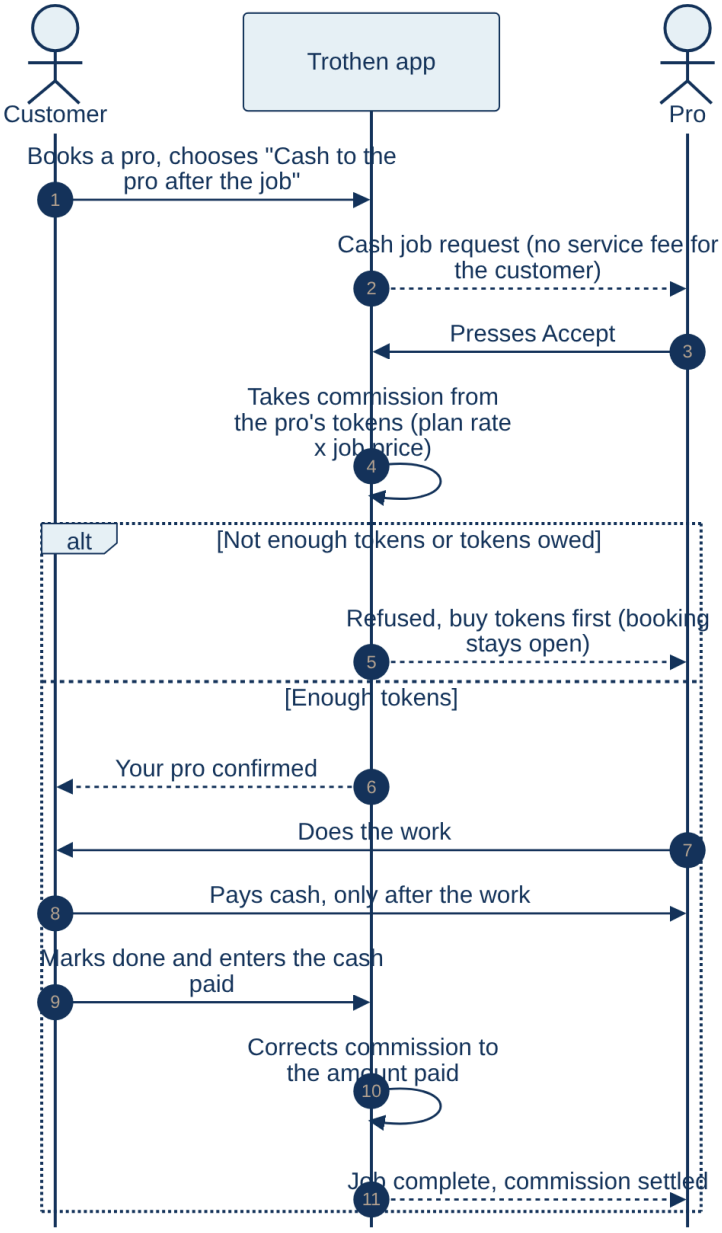
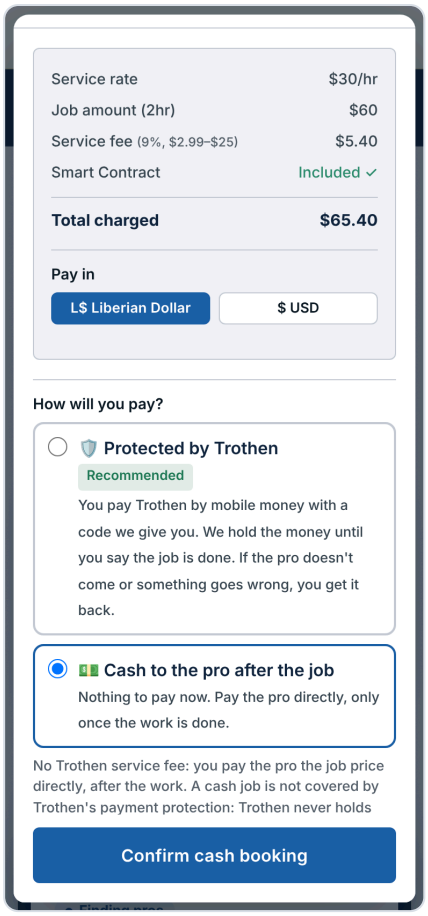
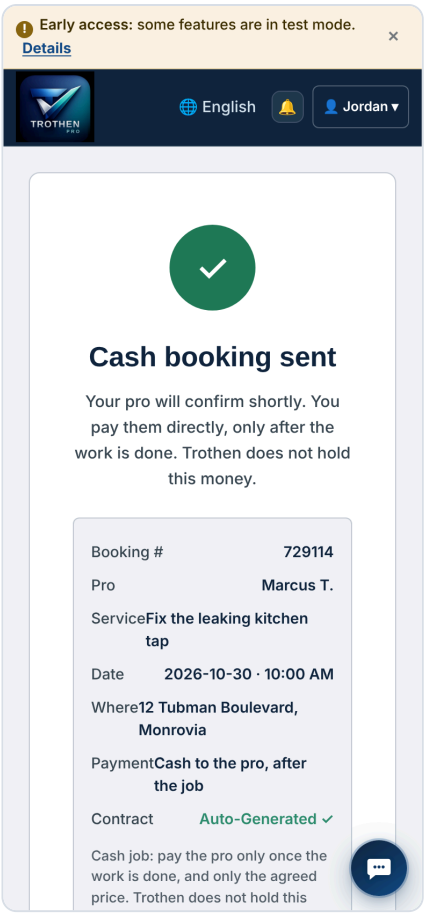


Figure 4.1: A cash job from booking to completion



4.2: Choosing cash shows a plain warning: no service fee, not covered by escrow, never pay before the work.



4.3: The confirmation says "Cash booking sent", not "held in escrow".

What the customer gets, and what they don't

Customer protection	Protected job	Cash job
ID-checked pro, written contract, ratings, booking record	**Yes**	**Yes**
Pay only after the work is done	**Yes (money held)**	**Yes (pay at the end)**
Money back if the pro doesn't come or declines	**Yes**	**Nothing was paid, so nothing to lose**
Money back after a dispute	**Yes, refund or split**	**No. Trothen never held the money. The team decides and can penalise the pro.**
Trothen service fee	9%, $2.99 to $25	**None**

Store goods, materials advance, loyalty points	**Allowed**	**Not allowed (they need Trothen to hold or pay money)**

Marking a cash job done

When the customer marks a cash job complete, the app asks **how much cash they paid**. It's filled in with the agreed price, and they change it if they paid more for extra work agreed on the spot. This number does two things: it corrects the pro's commission (section 6), and a gap of more than 15% raises a flag for the team to look at.

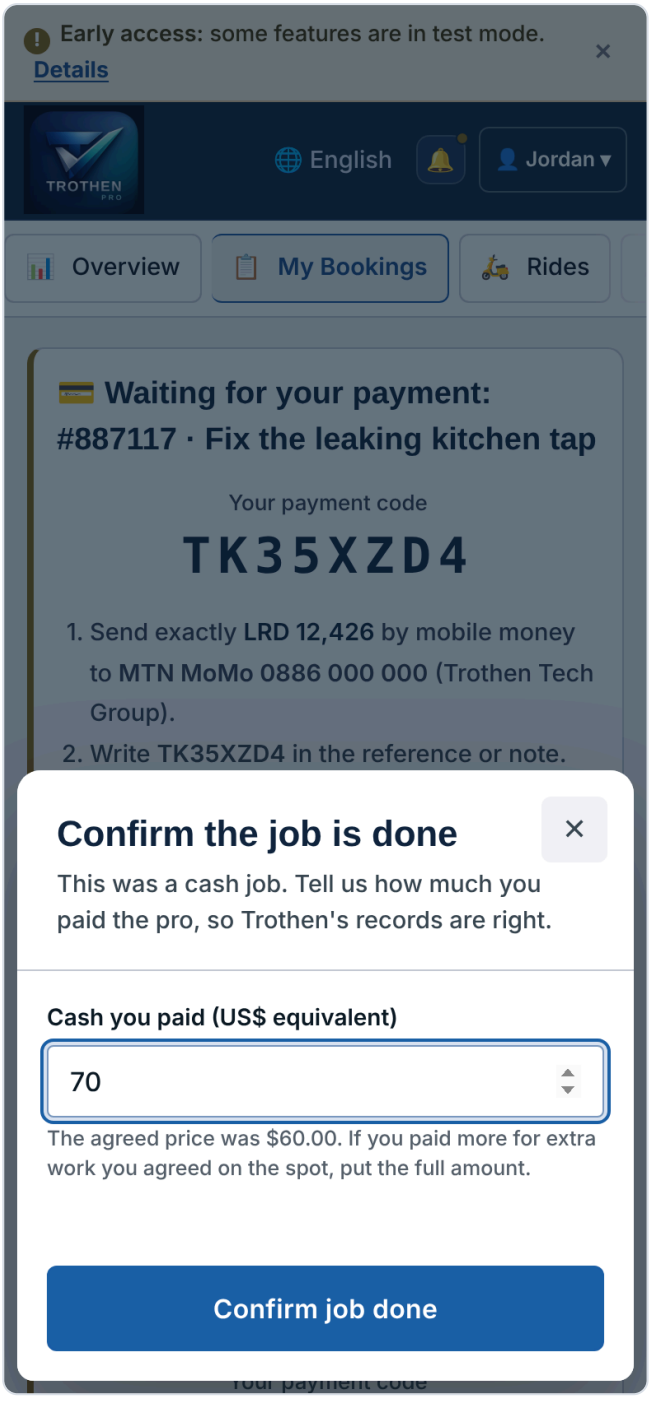


Figure 4.4: "Confirm the job is done" on a cash job asks for the cash paid.

Why the customer, not the pro, reports the amount

The pro has a reason to report less (less commission). The customer has no reason to report more than they paid. If the two disagree, the pro can report a problem, and big differences are flagged anyway.

5. Pro tokens: what they are and how pros buy them

A token is a prepaid credit a pro buys from Trothen and spends only on what they owe Trothen. **1 token is always worth US$1** when it's spent, so a pro's tokens keep their value even if the local currency falls. Bigger packs include bonus tokens.

Pack (Liberia, Ghana, Nigeria)	Tokens	Price	Example local price (Liberia)
Mini	2	$2	L$380
Small	5	$5	L$950
Medium	10.5 (0.5 bonus)	$10	L$1,900
Large	26.5 (1.5 bonus)	$25	L$4,750

Other countries default to $10 / $25 / $50 / $100 packs. Every pack, price and bonus can be changed per country. A pack can also have a fixed local price (for example ~~₦~~7,500), and the admin page marks it ⚠️ if the exchange rate moves 5% away from it.

Three ways a pro pays for tokens

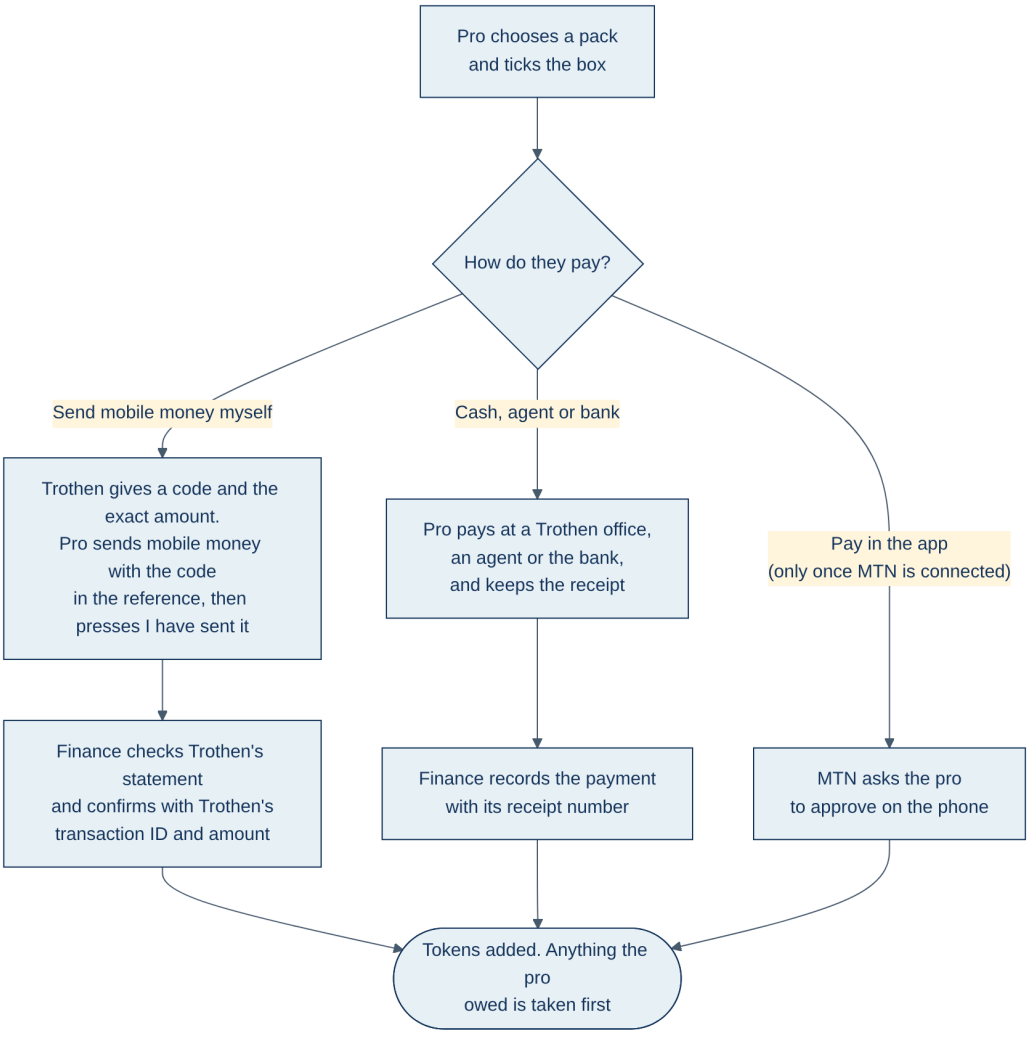
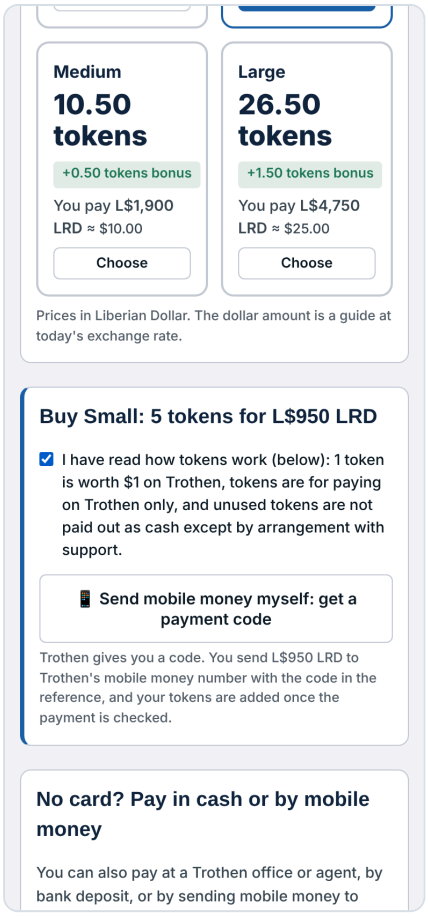
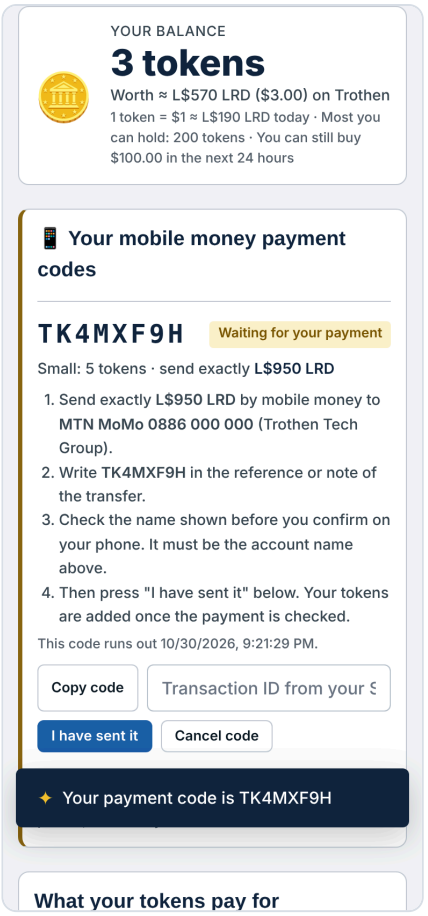


Figure 5.1: Buying tokens

Way	How it works	Available
Mobile money with a code	Exactly like a customer's protected payment: the system makes a code, the pro sends the money with the code in the reference and presses "I have sent it", and finance confirms it.	**Now**, wherever you've entered Trothen's number
Cash, agent or bank deposit	The pro pays at a Trothen office, an agent or the bank. Finance records it under *Look up a pro → Record a payment made outside the app*, choosing the pack or entering the amount paid, plus the receipt number.	**Now**
Pay in the app	MTN asks the pro to approve on their phone.	Only once the MTN connection is approved. Until then the button is hidden.



5.2: Choosing a pack. With no MTN connection, the pro is offered the payment code only.



5.3: The pro's payment code, with the amount, number and steps.

Limits that protect pros and Trothen

- **Only ID-verified pros can buy tokens.** A balance is stored money, so Trothen needs to know who holds it.
- **Most one pro can hold:** 200 tokens in Liberia, Ghana and Nigeria (500 elsewhere). **Most bought in 24 hours:** $100 there ($200 elsewhere). Open codes count toward both.
- **4 or more purchases in a day** raises a fraud flag for a person to check. It doesn't freeze the account.
- **At most 3 open codes per pro.** Codes run out after 48 hours if no payment is reported.
- **Each receipt or transaction number can be used once.** Staff can't type in a number of tokens when recording a payment; tokens are worked out from what was paid.
- **A weak signal can't cause a double purchase**: pressing again returns the same purchase or code.

6. Commission on cash jobs, step by step

This is how Trothen gets paid when the customer pays the pro in cash. The commission is the pro's plan rate times the job price: **13% Starter, 12% Pro, 10% Super Pro**. An approved individual rate or an organisation's negotiated rate is used instead when one applies.

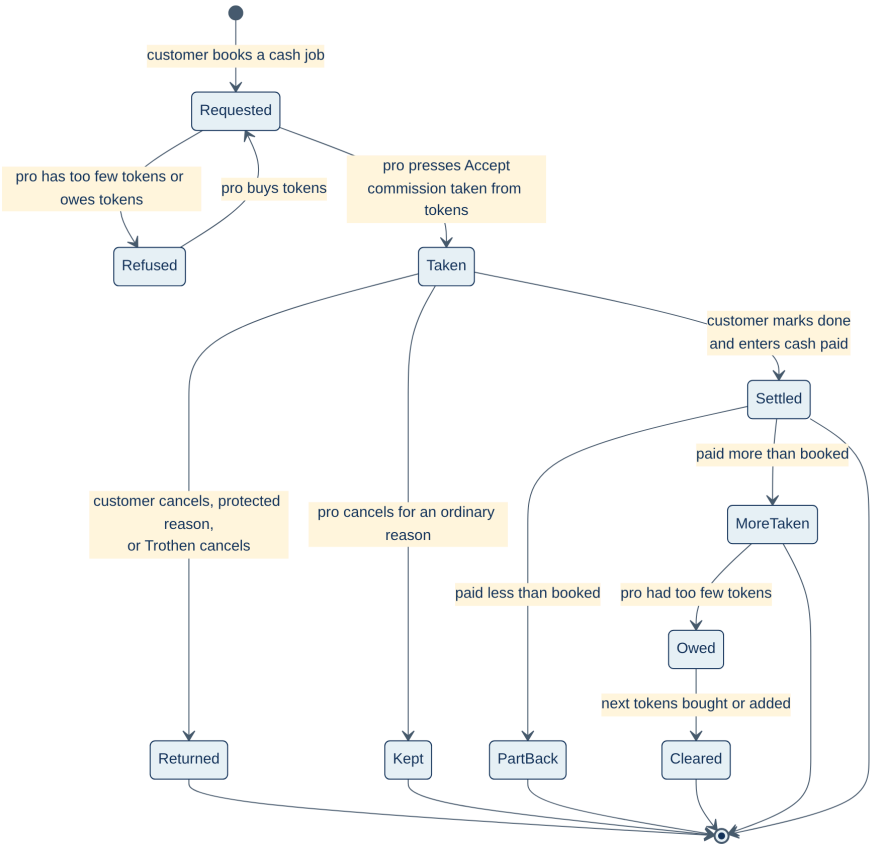


Figure 6.1: The life of a cash job's commission

Worked examples (Starter pro, 13%)

What happens	Tokens	Result
Pro has 3 tokens and tries to accept a $60 cash job.	Needs 7.8	Refused. The booking stays open, and the pro sees "Buy tokens".
Pro buys tokens and accepts.	7.8 taken	Job confirmed. The customer is told to pay the pro after the work.
Customer marks it done and says they paid $60.	No change	Commission stays at 7.8.
Customer says they paid $80 (extra work agreed).	2.6 more taken	Commission 10.4. Flagged (more than 15% over the booked price) for a quick check.
Customer says they paid $55.	0.65 back	Commission 7.15. Small gap, so no flag.

Customer paid $120 but the pro has 0 tokens left.	7.8 owed	The pro can't accept new cash jobs until they buy tokens. The owed amount is taken first from the next purchase.
Customer cancels after the pro accepted.	7.8 back	Returned straight away.
Pro cancels: "it became unsafe" (protected reason).	7.8 back	Doesn't count against the pro.
Pro cancels: "schedule conflict" (ordinary reason).	Kept	Stops "accept everything, then drop it".
Pro has a top-scorer free-commission credit.	0	One credit covers one cash job.

Why take it at "Accept" rather than at the end?

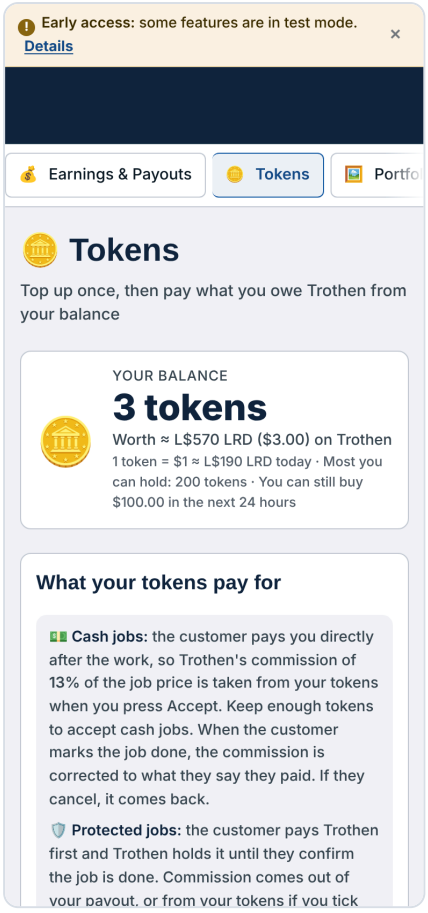
If Trothen waited until the job was done, a pro could take the job, collect the cash and never mark anything, and Trothen would get nothing. Taking it up front, and giving it back when it's fair, means Trothen is always paid for jobs that happen. Pros can't run up debts either: they can only owe after a customer reports paying more than booked, and then they're blocked until they top up.

7. Everything else tokens can pay for

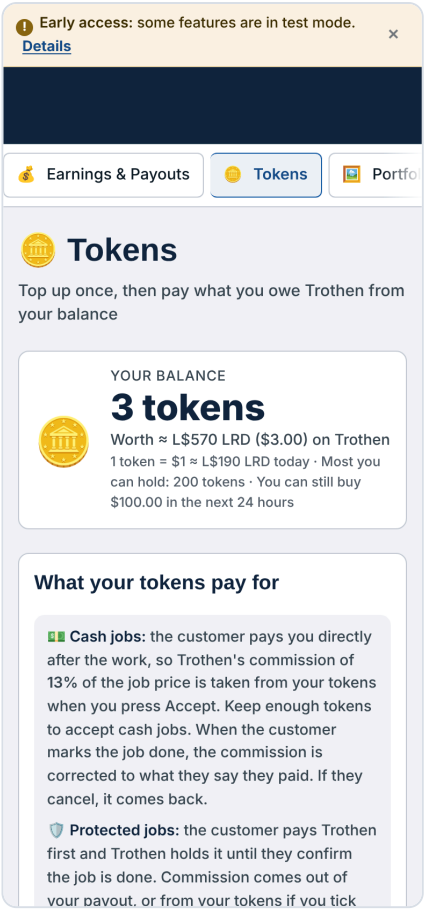
Besides cash-job commission, which is automatic, a pro can tick boxes on their Tokens page to pay these from tokens first:

Item	How it works with tokens	If tokens don't cover it
Commission on protected jobs	Taken from tokens when the pro cashes out, so they receive the full amount they earned. The payout record and message show how much tokens paid.	The rest comes out of the payout as before.
Monthly plan fee	Paid from tokens as soon as the month's invoice is made. There's also a "Pay with tokens" button on any open invoice.	The rest comes from payouts as before (plan billing is still switched off).
Self-serve ads	Paid from tokens when the balance covers the whole price.	Paid the usual way. Tokens come back if the ad is withdrawn before it runs, or turned down.
Driver pass	A daily, weekly or monthly pass is paid from tokens when the balance covers it.	Paid the usual way.

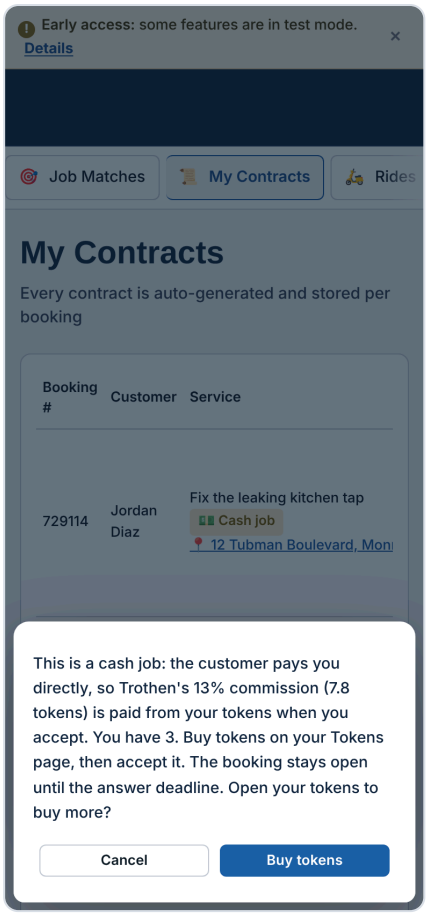
8. The pro's screens



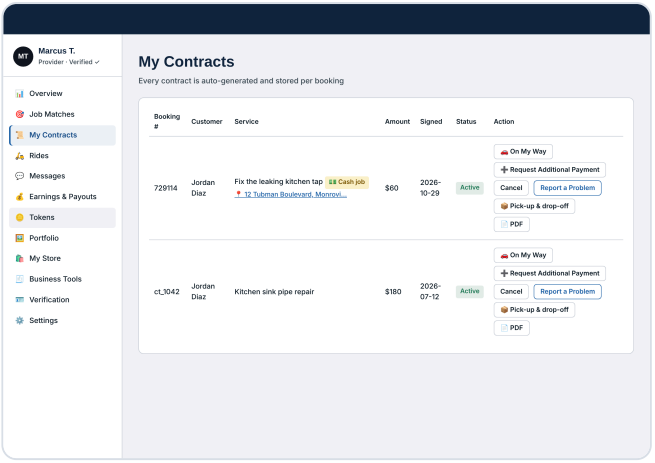
8.1: Tokens page. The balance is shown in local money, with today's value of 1 token and how much more can be bought today.



8.2: "What your tokens pay for": cash-job commission, protected jobs, and the boxes for commission, plan fee, ads and passes.



8.3: Accepting a cash job without enough tokens. The pro is told exactly why and can go straight to Tokens.



8.4: My Contracts. Cash jobs carry a "💵 Cash job" label.

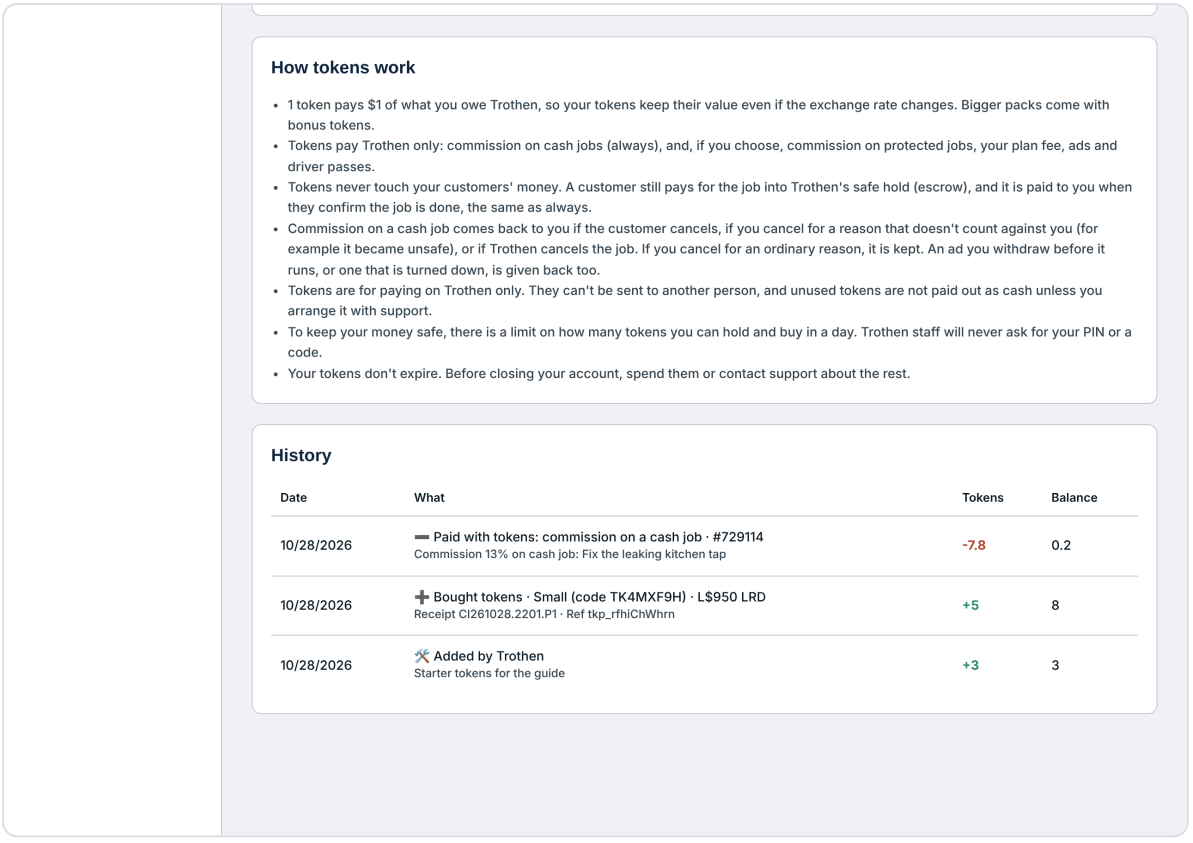


Figure 8.5: Token history. Every purchase (with its reference or receipt), every commission and every token given back, with the balance after each.

9. The finance team's daily routine

While payments are confirmed by hand, the finance team is what makes escrow real. I suggest set check times, for example 9:00, 13:00 and 17:00, and telling customers and pros those times.

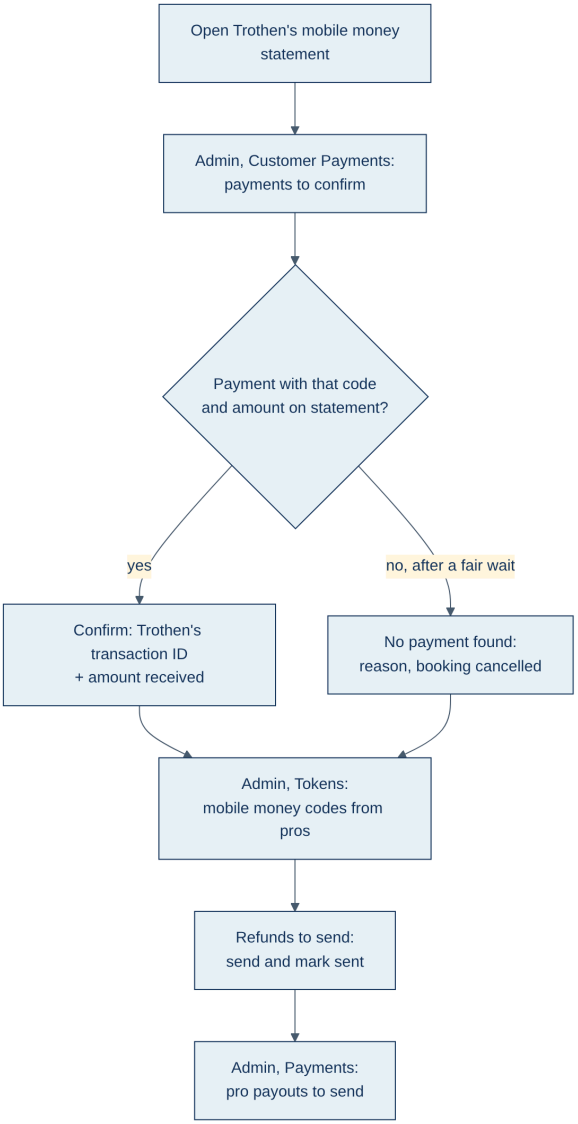


Figure 9.1: One round of checks

Each check, in order

1. **Open Trothen's mobile money statement**, for the official business number only.
2. **Admin → Customer Payments → Payments to confirm.** For each code, look for a payment with that code in the reference and at least that amount. If it's there, enter **Trothen's** transaction ID from the statement and the amount received, then press **Confirm payment**. The pro is asked straight away.
3. **If there's no payment after a fair wait** (customer says paid, but nothing after a day): write a reason and press **No payment found: cancel booking**. The customer is told.
4. **Admin → Tokens → Mobile money payment codes** (pros buying tokens): the same checks.

5. **Admin → Customer Payments → Refunds to send:** send each refund back to the number it came from, then enter the transaction ID and press **Mark refund sent**.
6. **Admin → Payments:** send pro payouts that are processing.
7. **Cash, agent or bank payments for tokens:** Admin → Tokens → Look up a pro → **Record a payment made outside the app**, with the receipt number.

Never do these

- Never confirm a payment you can't see on Trothen's own statement. A screenshot from a customer is not proof.
- Never use the customer's transaction ID in the "Trothen's transaction ID" box.
- Never confirm a short payment. Ask for the rest, or cancel and refund what arrived.
- Never pay a payout for a booking that wasn't really paid in. The live-site switch in section 10 stops this automatically once it's on.

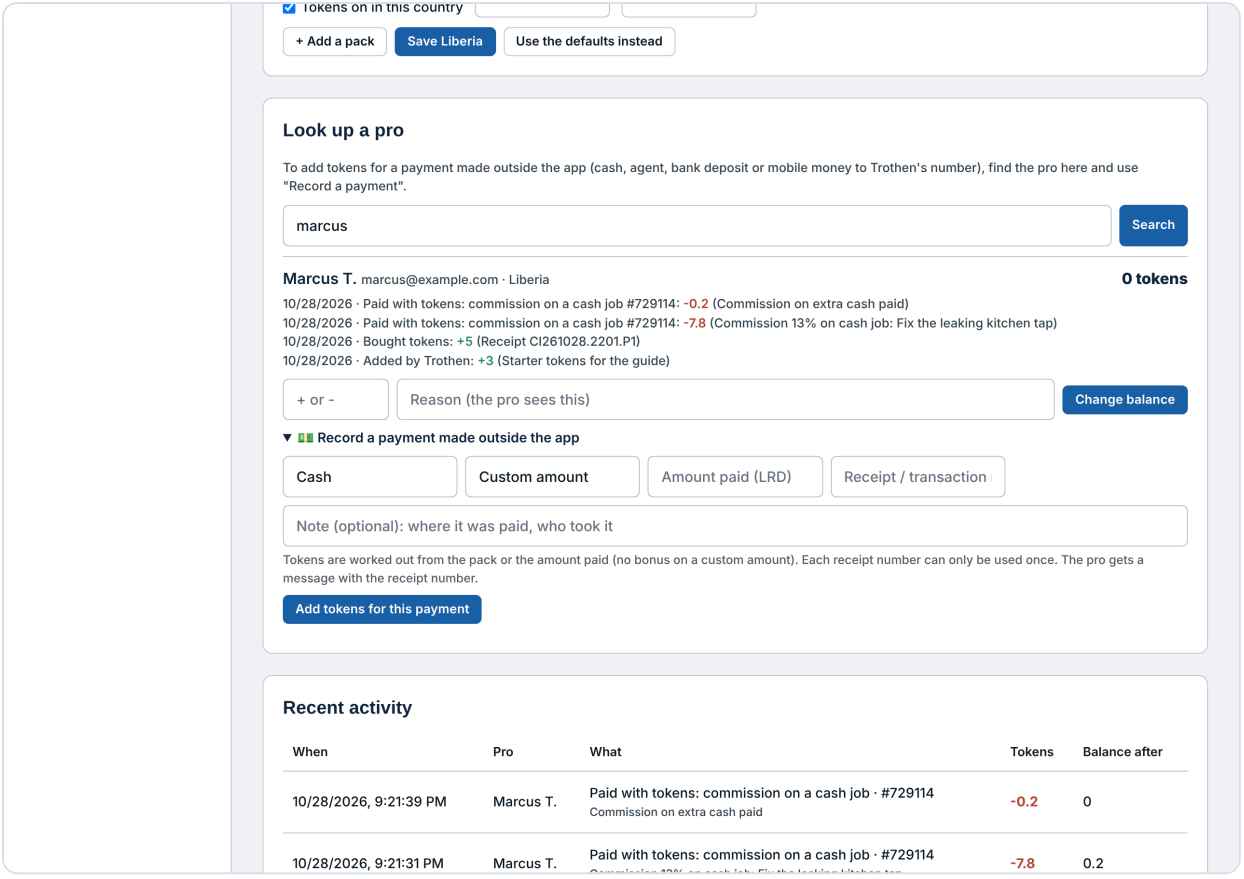


Figure 9.2: Look up a pro. Their balance, history, "Change balance" (super admin) and "Record a payment made outside the app" (finance).

10. Admin settings explained

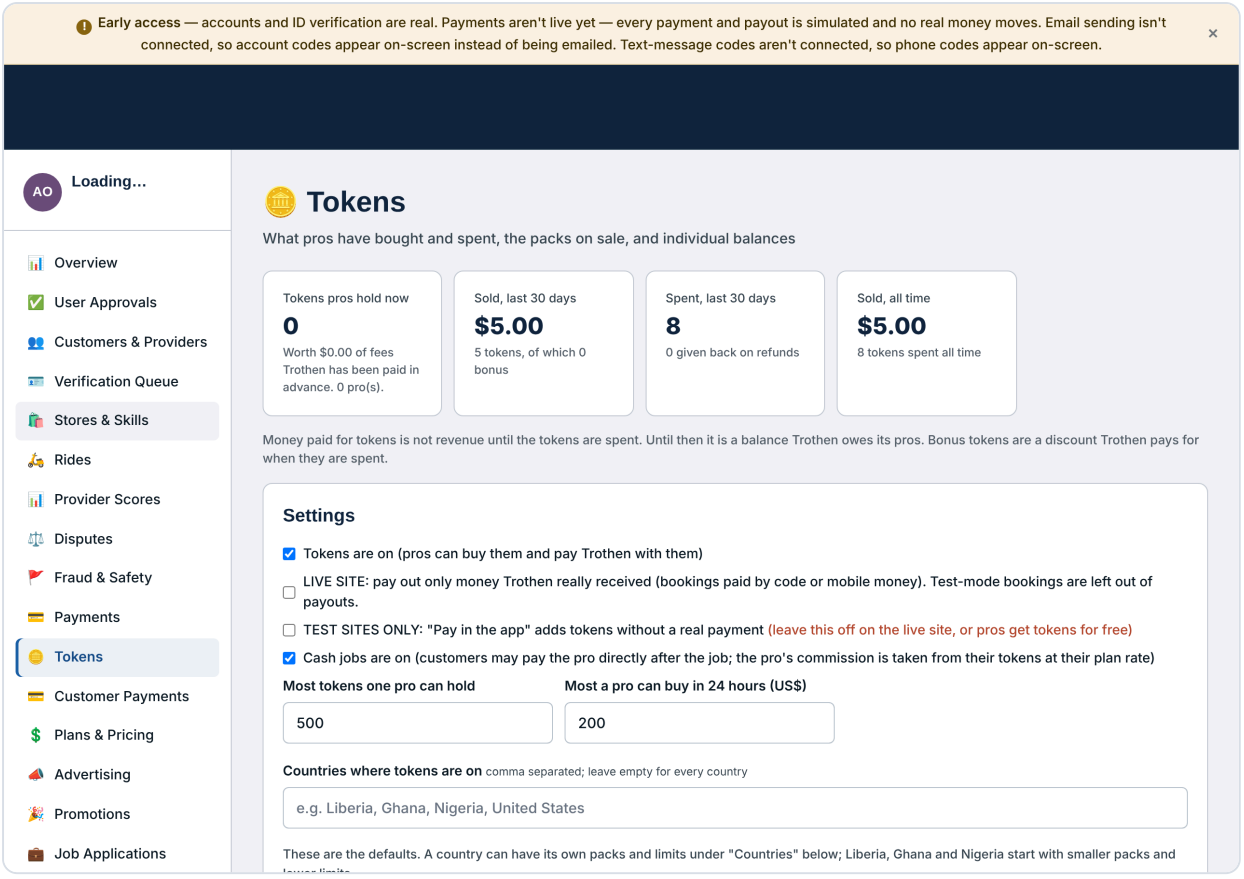
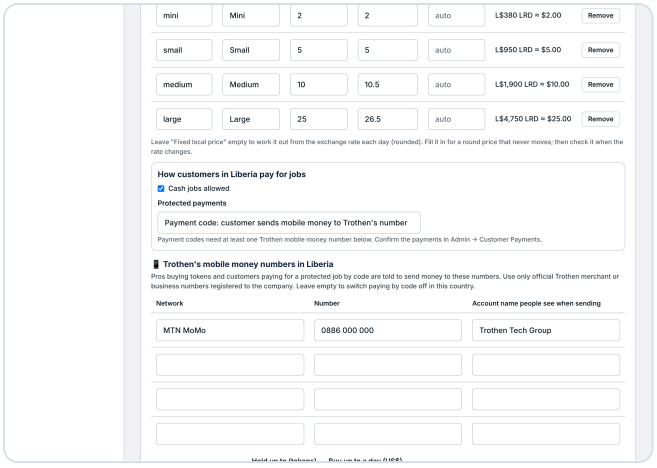


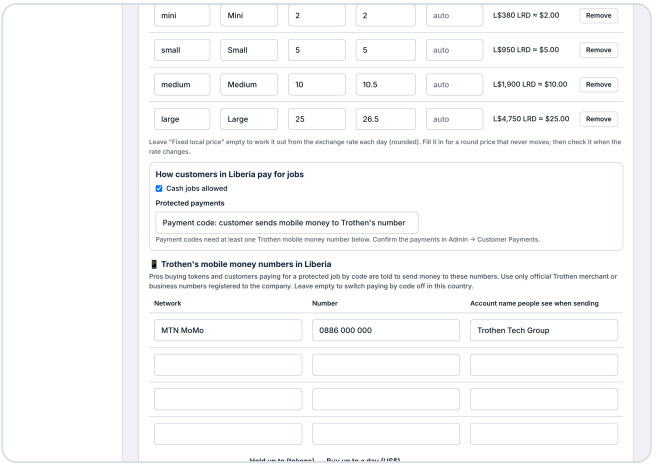
Figure 10.1: Admin → Tokens → Settings

Setting	What it does	For the live site
Tokens are on	Pros can buy tokens and pay Trothen with them.	On
LIVE SITE: pay out only money Trothen really received	Payouts only include bookings paid by a confirmed code or real mobile money. Test-mode bookings are left out.	**On**
TEST SITES ONLY: "Pay in the app" adds tokens without a real payment	For testing on your computer only. On the live site it would give pros free tokens.	**Off**
Cash jobs are on	Customers may choose "Cash to the pro after the job" (can also be set per country).	On, if you offer cash
Most tokens one pro can hold / buy in 24 hours	Defaults when a country has no rule of its own.	500 / $200
Countries where tokens are on	Empty means every country.	Your countries
Packs	Default packs: name, price and tokens (bonus = tokens above the price).	Your prices

Per country (Admin → Tokens → Countries)



10.2: Packs in local money, with the price people pay and the drift check.



10.3: How customers pay in that country, and Trothen's mobile money numbers.

- **Protected payments:** "As now (test mode)" or **"Payment code"**. Choose Payment code for every country where you operate for real.
- **Trothen's mobile money numbers:** up to four, each with network, number and the account name people will see when sending. Use only numbers registered to the company.
- **Cash jobs allowed:** switch cash jobs on or off for that country.
- **Packs, limits, fixed local prices:** as in section 5.

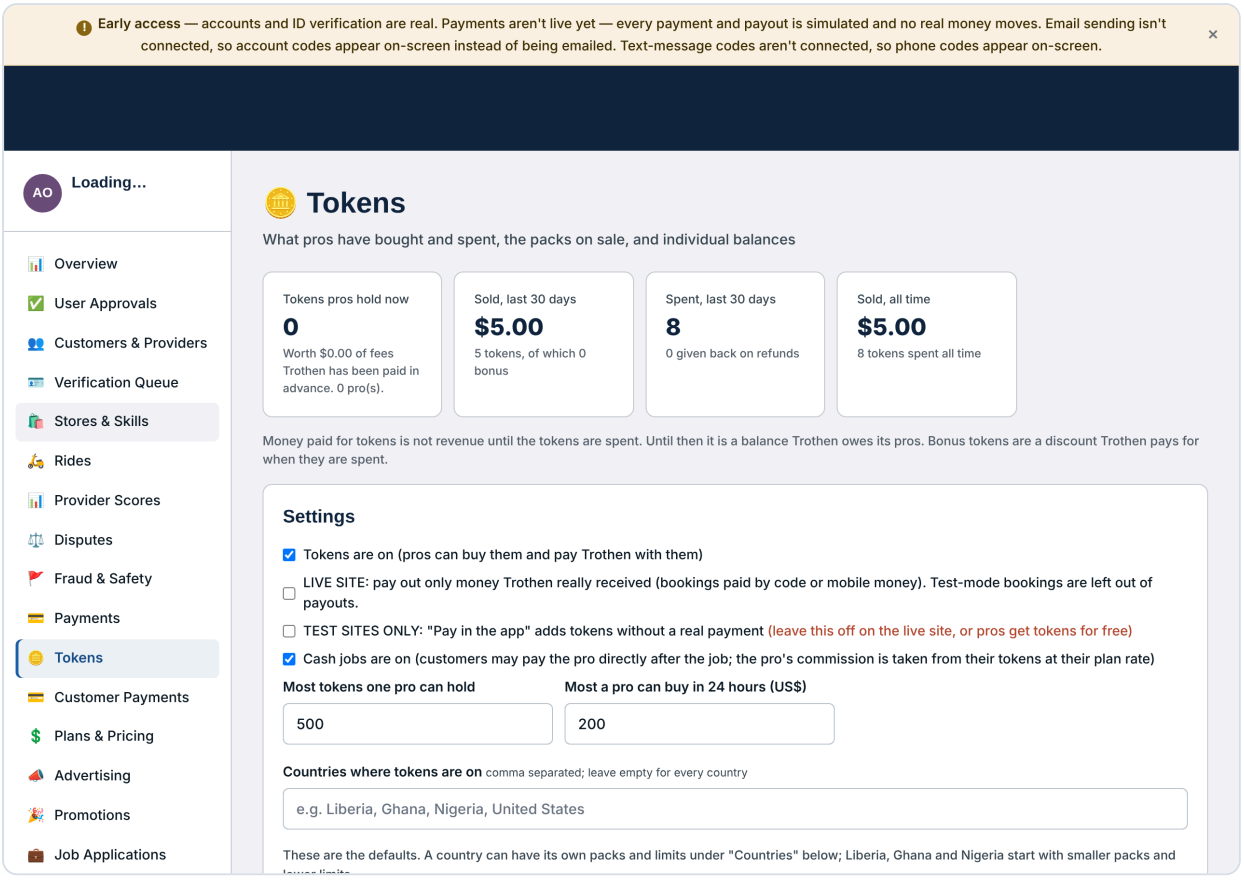


Figure 10.4: Admin → Tokens overview. Tokens pros hold now, sales, tokens spent and given back.

Who can do what: super admins can do everything. The finance team (financial, accountant, controller) can confirm payments, send refunds and record payments. Customer service can look but not move money. Every confirmation, refund, recorded payment and balance change is logged with who did it.

11. When things go wrong: every case

Situation	Protected (code)	Cash
Customer never pays the code	Booking cancelled after 24 hours; customer told; the pro never saw it.	Not applicable.
Customer says paid, but no money	Finance: "No payment found", with a reason. Booking cancelled.	Not applicable.
Customer sent less than asked	Confirm refused. Ask for the rest, or cancel and refund what arrived.	Not applicable.
Customer sent more than asked	Confirmed. The extra is recorded as overpaid; refund it by hand.	Not applicable.
Pro declines or doesn't answer (direct booking)	Refund listed for finance to send.	Nothing paid; customer told to try another pro.
Pro declines or doesn't answer (job board)	Money moves to the next interested pro. If nobody's left, the job reopens and the refund is listed.	Offered to the next pro (who needs tokens to accept).
Customer cancels before the work	Refund listed for finance.	Pro's commission back straight away.
Pro cancels (ordinary reason)	Refund listed for finance.	Commission kept.
Pro cancels (unsafe, wrong trade, licence)	Refund listed for finance.	Commission back.
Dispute decided for the customer	Full refund listed.	Decision recorded and both told. Trothen holds no money to refund; the team can penalise the pro.
Dispute split	Part refund listed; the rest goes to the pro.	Not possible (nothing held).
Extra work agreed during the job	"Request additional payment" as before.	Agreed price goes up. The customer reports the full cash paid, and commission is corrected.
Pro doesn't have enough tokens	Not needed (commission comes from the payout).	Can't accept until they top up.
Phone signal drops while paying	Pressing again gives the same code or purchase. Nobody is charged twice and nobody gets two codes.	

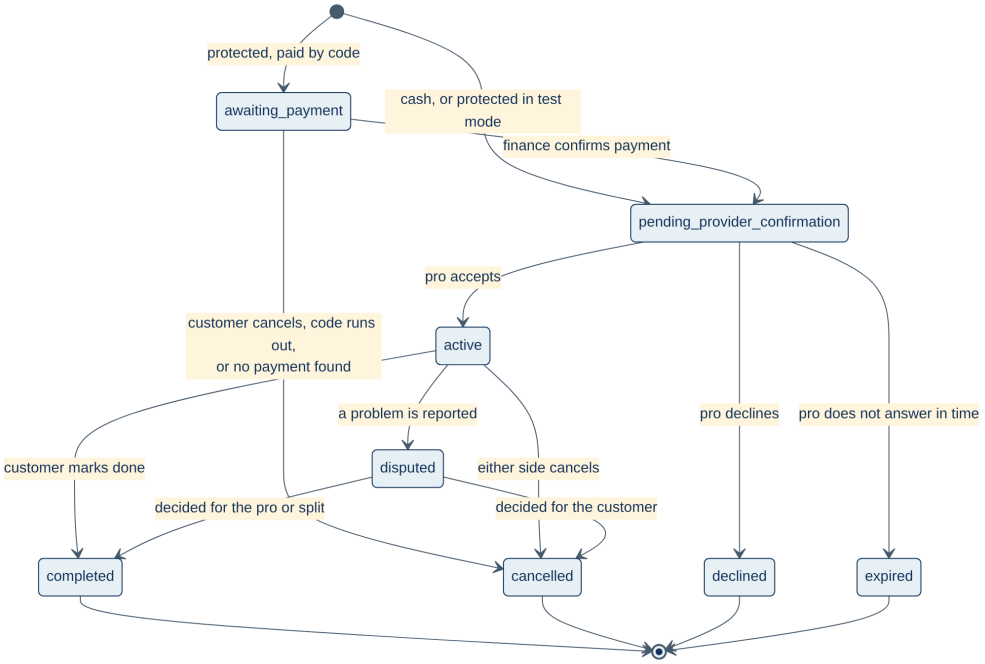


Figure 11.1: Every status a booking can go through

12. Safety and fraud controls

Risk	Control in the app
Fake "I paid" claims	Only staff who see the money on Trothen's statement can confirm. Customer screenshots aren't accepted.
The same payment counted twice	Each Trothen transaction ID and receipt can be used once, across everything.
Wrong amount sent	Short payments can't be confirmed. Overpayments are recorded.
Payout of money never received	Live-site switch: payouts only include bookings really paid in.
Free tokens	"Pay in the app" is refused unless real mobile money is connected; the test switch must stay off.
Staff adding tokens without payment	Recording a payment needs a receipt and works out tokens from the amount. "Change balance" is super-admin only, needs a reason the pro sees, and is logged.
Pros taking jobs off the app to avoid commission	No customer fee on cash jobs (less reason to leave the app), commission taken at accept, customer-reported amounts with mismatch flags, ratings and disputes only for jobs in the app. See section 13 for more you can add.
Under-reporting cash	The customer reports the amount; a gap over 15% raises a flag.
Stolen phone or mobile money account buying tokens	Holding and daily limits, ID-verified buyers only, and a velocity flag at 4 purchases a day.
Scammers asking customers to pay "a different number"	Every payment screen tells people to send only to the numbers shown, check the account name, and never share their PIN.
Pros running up debts	Debt only arises after a customer reports paying more; the pro is then blocked from cash jobs until it's paid, and account closure is blocked while they owe.

13. Is this best practice? Honest assessment

You asked me to make sure this is the best way to handle the situation. My honest view: **for where Trothen is now** (no card or in-app mobile money, a cash-heavy market, a small team), **this is a sound, best-practice design.** It follows the same patterns other African platforms use for cash. There are some things software alone can't do, and some next steps I'd add.

What this design does that matches good practice

Practice	How Trothen does it
Collect the platform's share in advance on cash work	On-demand platforms that allow cash usually collect their commission from the worker's in-app balance rather than chasing it afterwards. Trothen does the same with prepaid tokens, taken when the pro accepts.
Keep the safe option the default	Protected payment is shown first and marked Recommended. Cash carries a plain warning.
Escrow: never release money before the service	Unchanged. Money is released only on the customer's confirmation or a dispute decision.
Separation of duties	Customers and pros can only *report* payments. Finance confirms. Super admins change balances. Everything is logged.
Idempotency (no double charges)	One code per request, one use per transaction ID, safe retries on weak signal.
Small, capped stored balances	Holding and daily limits, ID-verified buyers. This keeps regulatory risk and fraud loss small.
Fight off-platform "offline" jobs	Ride platforms in Nigeria have found that off-app cash trips are a safety and revenue problem and have actively reduced them. Trothen gives cash jobs a proper place inside the app rather than pushing them outside it.

Where it falls short of the ideal, honestly

Gap	Why it matters, and the fix
Manual confirmation of payments	It's slower and relies on people. The ideal is a licensed payment partner whose system tells Trothen automatically when money arrives (MTN MoMo API in Liberia; Paystack, Flutterwave or similar in Nigeria and Ghana). Trothen's code is already prepared for MTN.
Holding customer money yourselves	Escrow is a regulated activity in most countries. Best practice is to hold it through a licensed partner or in a separate trust account approved by your lawyer. This is business and legal work, not code.

One person can confirm a payment	For larger amounts, best practice is a second person approving (maker-checker). I can add this if you want, for example for payments over $100.
No escrow on cash jobs	That's unavoidable with cash. The customer is protected by paying only after the work, and the app says so honestly.
Off-app leakage	Some pros will still try to take repeat customers off the app. Next steps I'd suggest: hide phone numbers until a booking is accepted (already the case for rides), reward pros for jobs done in the app (score, top-scorer credits), and a clear policy with penalties.

My recommendation

Go live with this design: protected payments by code in each country, and cash jobs paid for with pro tokens. Run finance checks at fixed times. In parallel, keep pushing the MTN approval and a licensed payment partner. When they arrive, "Pay in the app" switches on and confirmation becomes automatic, without changing how customers and pros use Trothen.

14. Status reference

Booking statuses

Status	Meaning
`awaiting_payment`	Protected booking waiting for the customer's code payment. Pros don't see it (except an offer they already accepted).
`pending_provider_confirmation`	Waiting for the pro to accept, within their answer time.
`pending_agreement`	An offer waiting for the pro's answer.
`active`	Accepted. The work is happening.
`completed`	The customer confirmed it's done.
`cancelled` / `declined` / `expired`	Didn't go ahead (see section 11).
`disputed`	A problem was reported; the dispute team decides.

Payment (escrow) statuses

Status	Meaning
`awaiting_payment`	Code issued, money not confirmed.
`held`	Money confirmed and held by Trothen.
`released`	Released to the pro (in their balance, or paid out).
`refunded`	Given back. Code-paid refunds appear in "Refunds to send" until marked sent.
`payment_expired` / `payment_rejected` / `payment_cancelled`	The code was never paid; nothing to refund.

Token history entries

Entry	Meaning
Bought tokens	A purchase, with its reference (and receipt for cash, agent or bank).
Paid with tokens: commission on a cash job	Taken when the pro accepted, or corrected at completion.
Paid with tokens: commission / plan fee / ad / driver pass	The pro's chosen bills.

Tokens given back	Commission or an ad given back, with the reason.
Added by / Removed by Trothen	A super admin's change, with the reason the pro saw.

15. Reports and accounting

- **Service-fee revenue** counts only bookings whose money was really held or released. Unpaid codes and cash jobs (which have no fee) are left out.
- **Commission on payouts** is unchanged and appears on each payout. The part paid from tokens is shown as *commissionPaidWithTokens*.
- **Cash-job commission** appears in the financial summary as *cashJobCommission*: tokens spent on cash jobs minus any given back.
- **Admin → Tokens** shows tokens pros hold now (prepaid fees Trothen still owes in services), sales in the last 30 days and all time, bonus tokens given, and tokens spent and given back.
- **Every booking's way of paying** (protected or cash) is in the bookings report.

> **For your accountant**
>
> Money received for tokens is a **liability** (prepaid fees) until the tokens are spent; it becomes revenue then. Bonus tokens are a discount. Escrow money is never revenue: it belongs to the customer until released to the pro. Only the service fee and commission are Trothen's.

16. Go-live checklist

Deploy (see DEPLOYMENT_STEPS_v119.md)

- ☐ Copy the files in, check every byte count, commit on the `v119-cash-jobs` branch.
- ☐ Test on your computer (`node server.js`), then merge to main and push.
- ☐ Check that store orders and app-paid rides work again (the v118.1 fix is inside v119).

Settings, straight after deploying

- ☐ Admin → Tokens → Settings: **TEST SITES ONLY off**, **LIVE SITE switch on**, Cash jobs on or off as you decide. Save.
- ☐ For each country: Countries → enter Trothen's official mobile money number(s) → Protected payments: **Payment code** → Save.
- ☐ Check the packs and prices in local money for each country.
- ☐ Check the exchange rates in Admin are current.

People and process

- ☐ Named finance staff with finance-team admin accounts, and set check times.
- ☐ A written refund procedure: who sends, how fast, from which number.
- ☐ A cash and agent procedure for selling tokens: receipts, a daily count, who may sell.
- ☐ Tell pros: buy tokens before accepting cash jobs, and how to buy them.
- ☐ Tell customers: what Protected means, and never pay cash before the work.

First real test, with real small amounts

- ☐ A protected booking paid by code, confirmed, accepted, completed, paid out.
- ☐ A token purchase by code, then a cash job accepted and completed with the cash amount entered.
- ☐ A cancellation and refund sent, marked sent, and the customer told.

17. What still needs business or legal action

None of these can be solved in code. Each one matters before real money flows at scale.

Item	What's needed
Holding customer money (escrow)	Your lawyer in each country (Liberia: Central Bank of Liberia; Ghana: Bank of Ghana; Nigeria: CBN) should confirm how Trothen may hold customer money. Often that means a licensed partner, or a separate trust or escrow account.
Pro token balances	Selling tokens only to pros, only to pay Trothen's own fees, capped and closed-loop, is lower risk than a wallet. Have it confirmed anyway.
Official business mobile money numbers	Registered to the company (not a staff member), with statement access for finance. Ask MTN whether collecting payments this way fits your merchant account terms.
Customer Terms	Explain protected payment by code, that cash jobs are not covered by escrow, and refund times.
Provider Agreement	Explain tokens, commission on cash jobs taken at accept, when it comes back, what's owed, and penalties for taking jobs off the app.
Accounting	Separate escrow, unspent tokens and Trothen's own money. Token sales are prepaid fees until spent.
Payment brand logos	The Payments page now shows the real Visa, Mastercard, American Express, Discover, PayPal and Apple Pay logos, from licensed open-source icon sets. Apple, PayPal, Visa and Mastercard only allow their logos where you really accept that method. Before the live site shows them, either connect a real processor for each method or hide the methods that don't work yet. Swap in each company's official download from its brand site at that point.
MTN (LCMMMI) and a payment partner	Keep pursuing them: they turn manual confirmation into automatic confirmation.

18. How I tested it

I ran every flow below against a real copy of the server, using the code you uploaded plus these changes, with a fresh database each time. I also went through the app in a real browser to take the screenshots in this guide. There were no errors in the server log or on any page.

Area	What was checked	Result
Cash jobs and commission	No escrow or fee; refused without tokens; 13% taken at accept; corrected up and down at completion; mismatch flag; returned on customer cancel; owed amount blocks new cash jobs and is cleared by the next purchase; cash offers; job-board cash hires; cash off per country.	**Pass**
Protected payments by code	Waiting for payment; hidden from pro; report paid; finance list; underpayment refused; confirm moves money to escrow and asks pro; cancel creates a refund to send; refund marked sent; unpaid code runs out; customer cancel before paying; transaction ID reuse refused; job-board money moves to the next pro; offers paid after acceptance.	**Pass**
Pro tokens	Codes, cash/agent/bank records, duplicate receipts refused, limits, velocity flag, in-app payment refused without MTN, commission from tokens at payout, plan fee, ads (and refund), driver pass.	**Pass**
Live-site payout switch	Test-mode booking left out of payout; code-paid booking paid out in full.	**Pass**
v118.1 fix (broken on the live site today)	Store order placed and cancelled (refund, stock back); app-paid ride requested and cancelled (refund).	**Pass**
Browser, phone and computer	All customer, pro and admin screens in this guide; no sideways scrolling on phones; no page errors.	**Pass**

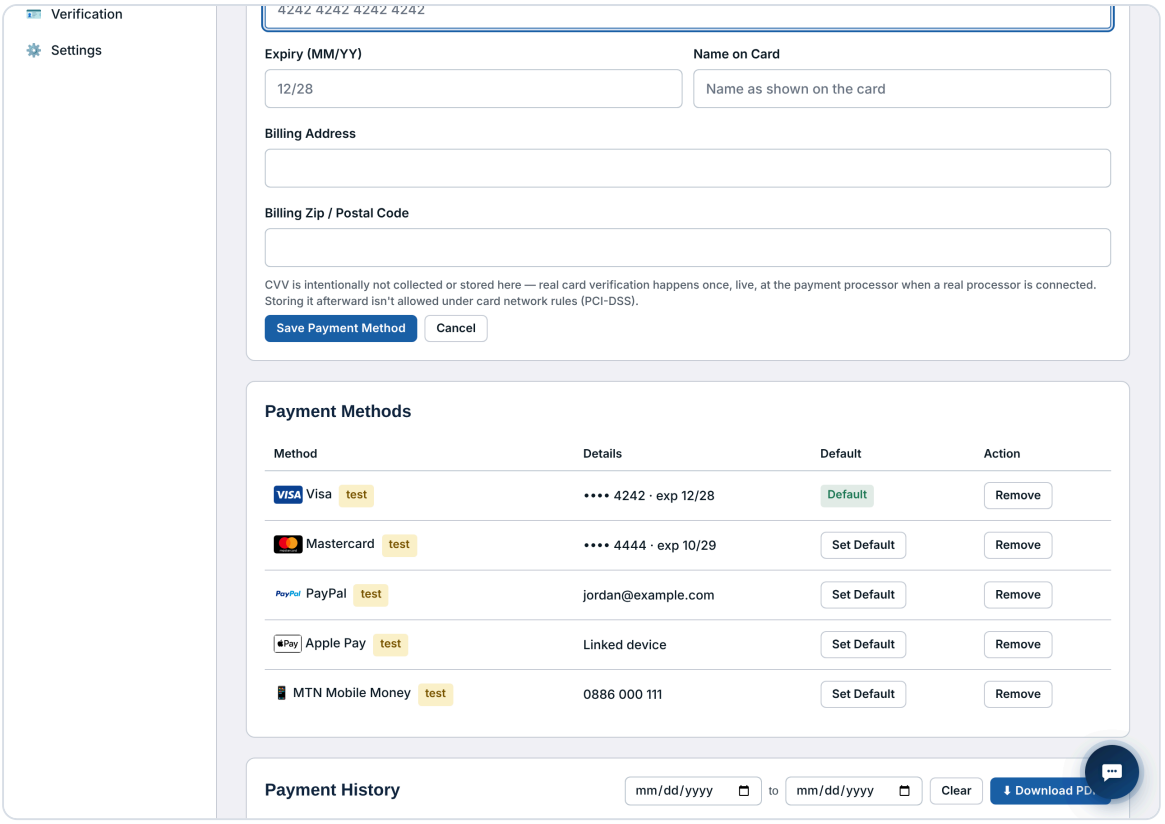


Figure 18.1: Payments page with the real payment logos (Visa, Mastercard, PayPal, Apple Pay). Mobile money keeps a phone icon, because no licensed MTN or Orange logo file was available to me.

87 automated checks in total. Not changed in v119: store orders and rides keep their earlier payment paths (store orders in test mode; rides with their own cash option).

19. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Escrow	Money Trothen holds for a customer until they confirm the job is done.
Protected job	A job paid to Trothen first and held in escrow.
Cash job	A job the customer pays the pro directly, in cash, after the work. Trothen holds nothing.
Payment code	A one-time code like TKV2E7AD that the system makes, written in the mobile money reference so finance can match the payment.
Token	Prepaid credit a pro buys from Trothen; worth $1 each when spent, used only to pay Trothen.
Commission	Trothen's share of a job price (13%, 12% or 10% by plan).
Service fee	What the customer pays Trothen on a protected job (9%, $2.99 to $25).
Owed (token debt)	Commission a pro couldn't cover after a customer reported paying more. Taken from their next purchase; blocks cash jobs until paid.
Test mode	Protected payments in a country without codes switched on: nothing real is paid in.
Maker-checker	A control where one person enters a money action and a second approves it.

Sources used for section 13

- TechCabal: "Over 80% of South Africa ride-hailing trips are cash-based, Bolt report finds" (17 April 2026) — https://techcabal.com/2026/04/17/over-80-of-south-africa-ride-hailing-trips-are-cash-based/
- AllAfrica / Bolt Nigeria: "Bolt Cuts Offline Trips By 42 Percent in Nigeria After Safety Crackdown" (July 2025) — https://allafrica.com/stories/202507140721.html
- Central Bank of Nigeria: Framework and Guidelines on Mobile Money Services in Nigeria (July 2021) — https://www.cbn.gov.ng/Out/2021/CCD/Framework and Guidelines on Mobile Money Services in Nigeria - July 2021.pdf